

would fill with wind by blowing into them, and so make them fly in the air, until the wind being exhausted, they dropped to the ground.”

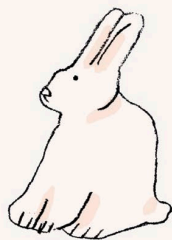
Even when Leonardo’s attention turned to painting, it could still be unpredictable. On one occasion when the pope entrusted him with a project, Leonardo’s first step was to consider what kind of varnish he would apply to the painting after he had finished it. According

to Vasari, the pope commented in some frustration that Leonardo “was a man to do nothing, for he thinks of the end before he begins his work.”



Although not politically

minded, Leonardo still occasionally found himself involved in delicate political situations. When the new king of France, Francis I, conquered Milan, the Medicis hoped to align



themselves with the French king rather than have to fight against him. So they turned to Leonardo for help.